development, pollution, and climate change have led to 50 percent of mangrove ecosystems being at risk of collapse.



Wetlands and intertidal zones are important for marine invertebrates and migratory shorebirds, but in many parts of the world they have been drained for industry and ports.

“In every walk with nature, one receives far more than he needs.”

John Muir

Halting the decline

The destruction of these habitats is not only a loss in terms of natural beauty and biodiversity, but also creates serious problems for people: for example, poorer water quality, declining fish stocks, crashes in populations of pollinators, flooding from increased rainwater runoff, and faster buildup of greenhouse gases. Conservation is now paramount, and ecologists work to refine their understanding of the best ways to go about it.